

- 512 MB RAM
- At least 3 GB free HDD space
(after you've installed the audio editor)
- Display card capable of a resolution of 1024 x 768 @ 32-bit colour
(for those expansive consoles that software today sport)

Now that we've got the rig set up, it's time to kit it out with some of the meanest audio editors on the market.

Among the freebies, the only two worth mentioning are Audacity and WaveLab. We introduce Audacity in §5.5.

WaveLab

WaveLab by Steinberg Audio is actually a full-fledged paid tool, but you can download a stripped-down free version too. Another winning tool, it has a robust and intuitive interface, making it very beginner-friendly. This, too, supports third-party VST plugins, so you'll never tire of all the effects you can have in a single package.



Steinberg's WaveLab

WaveLab has been touted as one of the quickest batch processors on the market, applying effects and filters to multiple files in a flash. It even lets you author your own audio, data, or hybrid CDs from within the program itself, including designing CD covers and graphics. The Audio Database, a much ignored feature in the software, lets you organise your sounds and music into categories—something that will be a lot of help if you have a huge collection of sound bites and loops that you'll use often.

Adobe Audition

A good while back, there was a program called Cool Edit Pro that did some wonderful things for the way people looked at sound editing. No more was it the domain of the sound engineer—even